



of understanding. You can protect your idea for under ₹100,000. It is not necessary to file a US patent immediately. There are ways to preserve the idea now and file internationally later, if needed.

Intellectual property management know-how is essential for anyone pursuing a technology-based business. In technology application, the ideal timeline for an idea to a working business model should not exceed three years. If it does, something is likely wrong. If you are still struggling after three years, others

Building a strong network of advisors is a wise allocation of an entrepreneur's resources. Now, let us clarify the terms: technology, product, and service in the context of business models. Business model is the strategy (choices you make) to make money (cashflow, profitability). The operating model is your means to execute your business model and strategy.

Many in India describe their work as a service business model, but in reality, it is labour provisioning. For example, a chartered

highly subjective and competitive.

A technology-enabled service business model in our context is about delivering a transactional experience, supported by a product, or many products, combined with intangible intellectual property. The essential difference of the technology service business model is that its transaction capability can scale up or down nonlinearly on demand, vis-à-vis the number of people (and resources) deployed. The difference also lies in the payment mechanism. With a service, you pay per transaction. You do not buy the car; you only buy the ride (consumption value). The service business model transforms the raw technology capabilities into a customer experience priced appropriately for the customer's context. Economically, it converts capital investment into operating costs, and transactional revenue. Imagine all that is involved behind an airline business that ultimately sells you a ticket to travel to a destination and gets you there safely and promptly. A structured business service can be priced based on the value it delivers. It has defined operations and a replicable model.

A product is sold once and used repeatedly. For instance, air-conditioning as a service—rented, maintained, and billed monthly—is an example of servitisation of air-conditioning. Buying the AC unit makes it a product buy. The underlying cooling mechanism—energy efficiency, auto controls—is the technology that is embedded. Technology itself is not consumed; it enables the product and the customer experience. The critical takeaway for a technology inventor is to consider the most suitable model for their invention: technology licensing, product creation, or service enablement? Each business

**RAISING CAPITAL IS A JOURNEY. FROM IDEA TO BUSINESS MODEL FIT, IT IS CHALLENGING. INVESTORS SEEK HIGH RETURNS BECAUSE SAFER OPTIONS, SUCH AS MUTUAL FUNDS OR LENDING, OFFER GOOD RETURNS AT A LOWER RISK. UNDERSTAND THIS BEFORE YOU APPROACH INVESTORS.**

will likely have already executed the same idea.

Should you take professional assistance? Yes. Whether it is venture capital or government funding, you require specialists to help you secure these funds. You cannot manage everything alone. Many fail because they attempt to do so. Many entrepreneurs do not internalise or are experienced with opportunity cost and non-binary decision-making. You are an expert in engineering and technology. But when it comes to presenting your idea to others who are not familiar with the depths and nuances of your know-how, you will benefit from others who can support you. There are specific processes, taxonomy, and norms followed by other agencies such as government grant providers, angel investors, and venture capitalists.

accountant or IT consultant or a plumber billing by the hour or as a flexible retainer is essentially selling labour, without direct employment conditions. These are professional services and have a time-tested, proven business model, and they have limited scalability due to the tight relationship with the number of people (and resources) deployed.

Labour arbitrage is an important global economic opportunity that India has been benefiting for decades. A professional may earn \$65,000 in the United States and ₹650,000 in India. Someone builds technology to facilitate the labour delivered as a service remotely. A labour-based business is entirely valid. However, it is similar to employment—trading time for money. For example, how much would someone pay for one hour of your time? That makes its value